

4th Annual Meeting of the European Network of Open Criminology

General Assembly Minutes

Wednesday, September 9, 15:00 to 16:30, Room 2.164, Faculty of Applied Languages, University of Warsaw.

Attended: Alexander Trinidad, Amy Nivette, Asier Moneva, David Buil-Gil, Iain Brennan, Isabelle van der Vegt, Matt Ashby, Maximilian Pickartz, Réka Solymosi, Trevor Calafato, Wim Bernasco, Wouter Steenbeek

(Note: Scott Jacques joined online for item 3.)

Minutes: Asier Moneva

Opening: Isabelle van der Vegt

1. Approval of previous minutes

Resolution: The minutes from the previous meeting (https://github.com/ESC-ENOC/esc-enoc.github.io/blob/main/minutes_2025_finished.pdf) were reviewed and approved.

2. Annual report of activities

Highlights: Isabelle presented key highlights from the annual report, including among others:

- The ESC newsletter article (<https://escnewsletter.org/archive/criminology-is-lagging-behind>)
- The ENOC newsletter (https://esc-enoc.github.io/enoc_newsletter/)
- ENOC's contribution to the ESC Summer School (presented by Sandy Schumann).
- Sponsorship of the Open Criminology Award (https://esc-enoc.github.io/open-crim-award_v2.html)

Discussion: Matt inquired about the participants' reactions to the Summer School. It was noted that Sandy would be the best person to provide this feedback. Wim asked if there had been any feedback regarding the ESC newsletter article. Isabelle replied that none had been received so far. Wouter asked for updates on the how-to guides, the book, and the webinar. It was explained that these projects were either not current priorities or had been delayed due to competing workloads.

Resolution: The annual report was approved.

3. Awards

Announcements: Isabelle announced the winners of both awards:

- Danielle Stibbe for the NSCR Open Criminology Award for Early Career Researchers.
- Scott Jacques for the MPI-CSL Open Criminology Award for Established Researchers.

Sponsorship: Asier and Alex explained the process of securing sponsorship and invited other members to explore additional funding sources.

Guest Acceptance: Scott joined the meeting online to express his gratitude for the award.

4. Proposals for discussion

Alex presented two initiatives for ENOC to potentially promote or adopt within criminology: Codecheck and Peer Community In (PCI).

Discussion about Codecheck: Matt explained that Codecheck could serve as a mechanism to improve the reproducibility of researchers' code. Amy and Wouter questioned the adoption rate of this initiative in other disciplines and its viability within criminology. Wouter noted that fear of judgment or embarrassment over code quality might act as a barrier to adoption for some researchers. Wim raised concerns about how the system would function if authors are unable to share their underlying data. Reka pointed out that even attracting a few external users to adopt the system would be a great success. Amy and Matt suggested that implementing Codecheck might be premature. They recommended focusing on building general awareness around open coding practices first. Wouter questioned whether active contribution to Codecheck aligns with ENOC's core activities. Matt indicated that a primary hurdle would be successfully embedding the system into existing academic journals. David noted that if an individual member is passionate about pursuing the initiative, they should be encouraged to do so.

Discussion about Peer Community In (PCI): Alex clarified that PCI functions as an independent journal system. Wouter highlighted that PCI allows preprints to be reviewed regardless of the final publication outcome. Furthermore, under positive reviews, partner journals ("PCI-friendly" journals) would accept the paper without repeating the peer-review process. Amy asked if criminology journals need to be involved at this stage. Reka inquired about the current reputation of the PCI journal system. Wouter questioned the distinct benefits of PCI over traditional peer review and existing journals.

Matt expressed concern that current academic incentive and reward structures might hinder the strategy's success. He also questioned the operational differences between establishing a PCI community versus starting a Diamond Open Access criminology journal from scratch. Isabelle suggested contacting existing PCIs to learn from their operational experiences. David asked whether the interest in PCI stems from the difficulty of building journal infrastructure from scratch, or if it genuinely offers a superior approach. Amy recommended securing a clear estimate of the workload required for this initiative.

Resolution: David proposed forming a small task force to assess the pros and cons of creating a Diamond Open Access journal versus establishing a PCI. The attendees agreed with the proposal. David volunteered to join the group, and Alex agreed to coordinate the task force.

5. Membership

This agenda item was deferred to a future meeting.

6. Future activities and leadership

Call for Ideas: Isabelle requested that attendees email any suggestions for upcoming activities.

Upcoming Elections: Isabelle announced that the current Chair's term will conclude next year. She invited members to begin considering potential candidacies.

7. Any other business

Social Event: Isabelle informed the group that attendance at the social event following the conference will be voluntary.

Appendix: Open Criminology Award

Report of the Award Committee

Overview

The committee had expected a larger number of nominations but nevertheless found the evaluation process to be smooth and efficient. A clear consensus was reached on the recipients of both awards, and committee members' scores were generally well aligned across all nominees. Assessments were based solely on the evidence provided in the nomination materials. The committee noted that some nominators were more successful than others in demonstrating how their nominees met the award criteria, resulting in stronger and more compelling nominations.

At the same time, the committee recognized that there are naturally different ways of interpreting open science practices and evaluating the supporting evidence. As a result, determining the relative importance of different contributions involved a degree of subjectivity. Some variation in scoring was also observed among committee members, with some tending to score more generously and others more conservatively.

The committee found it more challenging than anticipated to evaluate early-career researchers using the existing rubric. In particular, contextualizing early-career achievements relative to those of more established researchers was not an easy task, which in general resulted in lower scores for early-career nominees.

Procedure

The award committee consisted of four members: the three Co-Chairs and one external member. Among these four committee members, both sponsoring organizations, NSCR and MPI-CSL, were represented.

After applying the eligibility and exclusion criteria, the committee considered five nominations for the Early Career Researcher award and seven nominations for the Established Researcher award (Figure 1).

A total of seven scorers participated in the award evaluation process, including the three ENOC Co-Chairs. Conflicts of interest were identified for a small number of nominations. These arose when a scorer had previously studied with a nominee or had worked with them through activities such as co-authorship or co-teaching. In such cases, the conflicted scorer was replaced by an alternative scorer for the evaluation of that nomination.

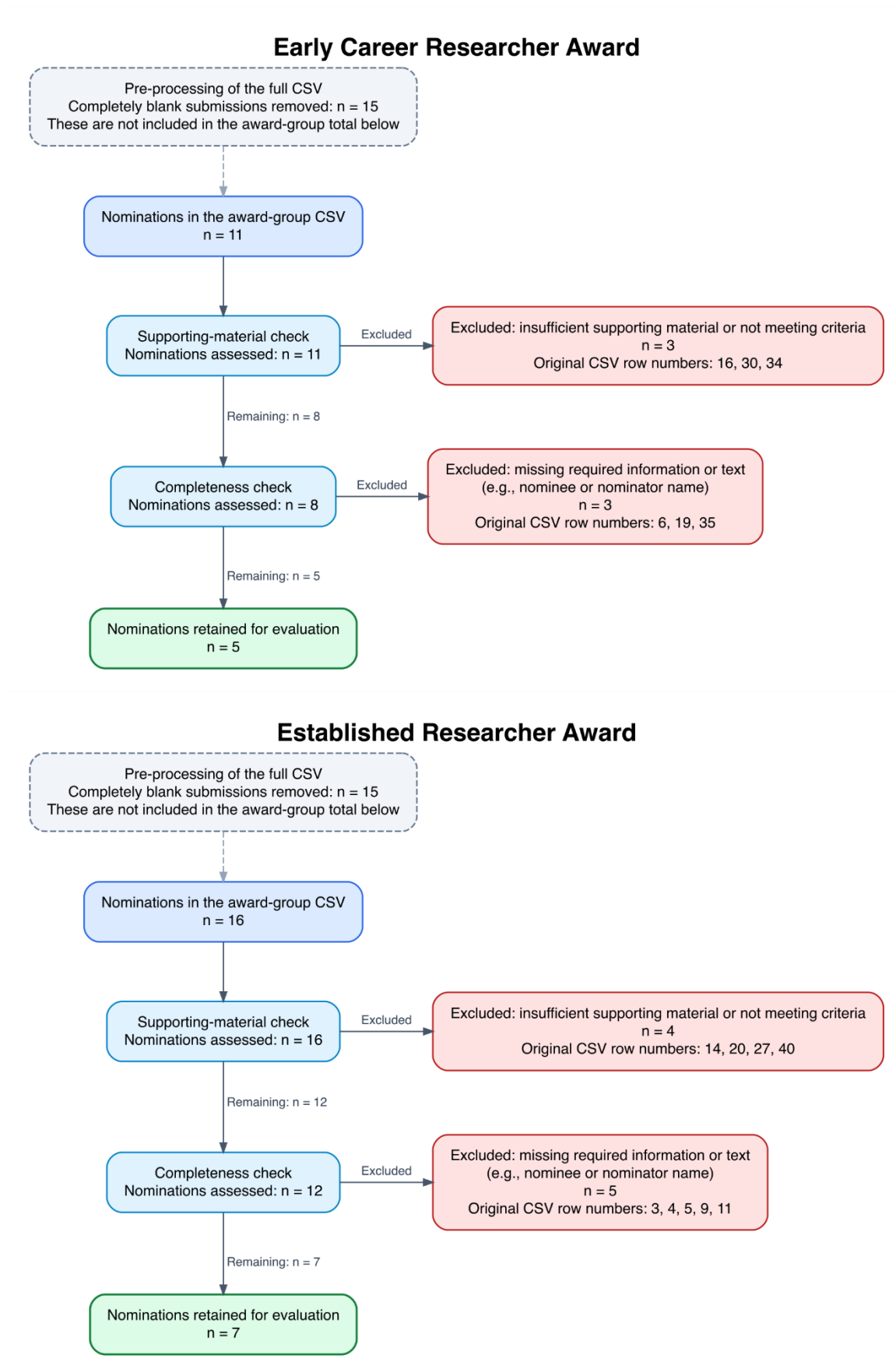


Figure 1. Nomination selection flow diagram

Each nominee was evaluated using standardized rubric (Figure 2). Based on this rubric, every nomination received three independent scores from three different scorers, with one score per scorer. The distribution of scoring assignments across the seven scorers was as follows: Scorer 1 evaluated 7 nominations, Scorer 2 evaluated 8, Scorer 3 evaluated 9, Scorer 4 evaluated 2, Scorer 5 evaluated none, Scorer 6 evaluated 2, and Scorer 7 evaluated 8 nominations.

Criterion	Weight	0	1	2	3	4	5	Score (0–5)	Weighted Score
Commitment to open research	35%	No evidence provided.	Minimal engagement with open research practices.	Some evidence of adopting or supporting open research practices.	Consistent engagement and promotion of open research practices.	Significant leadership and sustained commitment with clear influence on others.	Field-leading contribution that has substantially advanced open criminology.		
Impact and reach	30%	No demonstrated impact.	Limited impact within a small audience.	Some evidence of influence on research, policy, practice, or public engagement.	Clear and meaningful impact beyond the nominee's immediate network.	Significant influence across multiple communities, sectors, or regions.	Exceptional and sustained impact on criminology and/or society.		
Innovation	20%	No evidence of innovation.	Limited novelty.	Some innovative approaches evident.	Clear innovation that advances openness and transparency in criminology.	Highly innovative contribution adopted or emulated by others.	Groundbreaking innovation that has significantly transformed open criminology.		
Collaboration and inclusivity	15%	No evidence provided.	Limited collaboration or inclusivity efforts.	Some evidence of collaboration, community engagement, or inclusivity.	Strong interdisciplinary, international, or community engagement efforts.	Significant leadership in fostering inclusive and collaborative networks.	Outstanding contribution resulting in broad, sustained, and diverse participation.		
TOTAL	100%								

Figure 2. Committee scoring rubric

The rubric scores were averaged to produce a ranking of candidates. The committee reviewed and discussed the resulting rankings and agreed that they provided a fair representation of the nominees' merits. This process led to the unanimous selection of one winner for each award category.